REGIONAL DEVELOPMENT AND FIVE YEAR PLANS

DIVERSITY VERSUS DISPARITY → UNEVEN DEVELOPMENT DRIVERS → GROWTH POLE MECHANISM → CORE-PERIPHERY AND BACKWASH → PLANNING REGION CRITERIA → INDIAN PLANNING TIMELINE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW ◆ SUBORDINATE EXTRA ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g5 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00 STAGE 00 — DIVERSITY VERSUS DISPARITY

DIVERSITY VERSUS DISPARITY · DIFFERENCE OF CHARACTER · LANGUAGE, ECOLOGY, CULTURE, CROPS · RANKED INEQUALITY · INCOME, LITERACY, HEALTH, INFRASTRUCTURE · DIVERSITY IS ACCOMMODATED; DISPARITY IS REDUCED · TREATING INEQUALITY AS HARMLESS VARIETY IS A DIRECT EXAM MUST REMEMBER

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
DIVERSITY → difference of character: language, ecology, culture, crops	POLICY → diversity is accommodated; disparity is reduced	MUST REMEMBER: Regional development links spatial inequality, cumulative causation, growth poles, spread and backwash, core-periphery, agropolitan
DISPARITY → ranked inequality: income, literacy, health, infrastructure	TRAP → treating inequality as harmless variety is a direct exam error	and balanced/unbalanced strategies to India's planning regions, river-valley projects, industrial location, infrastructure corridors and district-level intervention.

CORE CLAIM
- DIVERSITY → difference of character: language, ecology, culture, crops
- DISPARITY → ranked inequality: income, literacy, health, infrastructure

MECHANISM
- POLICY → diversity is accommodated; disparity is reduced
- TRAP → treating inequality as harmless variety is a direct exam error

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- MUST REMEMBER: Regional development links spatial inequality, cumulative causation, growth poles, spread and backwash, core-periphery, agropolitan
- and balanced/unbalanced strategies to India's planning regions, river-valley projects, industrial location, infrastructure corridors and district-level intervention.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → treating inequality as harmless variety is a direct exam error.

01 STAGE 01 — UNEVEN DEVELOPMENT DRIVERS

UNEVEN DEVELOPMENT DRIVERS · RESOURCE ENDOWMENT · MINERALS, FERTILE LAND, PORTS OR IRRIGATION CLUSTER GROWTH · TRANSPORT + MARKET · CORRIDORS AND URBAN NODES OUTPACE INTERIORS · HISTORICAL HEAD START · EARLIER CENTRES KEEP CUMULATIVE ADVANTAGE · STATE CAPACITY

RESOURCE ENDOWMENT → minerals, fertile land, ports or irrigation cluster growth → TRANSPORT + MARKET → corridors and urban nodes outpace interiors → HISTORICAL HEAD START → earlier centres keep cumulative advantage → STATE CAPACITY → policy and governance decide whether lagging regions catch up

CORE CLAIM
- RESOURCE ENDOWMENT → minerals, fertile land, ports or irrigation cluster growth
- TRANSPORT + MARKET → corridors and urban nodes outpace interiors

MECHANISM
- HISTORICAL HEAD START → earlier centres keep cumulative advantage
- STATE CAPACITY → policy and governance decide whether lagging regions catch up

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- RESOURCE ENDOWMENT → minerals, fertile land, ports or irrigation cluster growth
- TRANSPORT + MARKET → corridors and urban nodes outpace interiors

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: STATE CAPACITY → policy and governance decide whether lagging regions catch up.

02 STAGE 02 — GROWTH POLE MECHANISM

GROWTH POLE MECHANISM · PROPULSIVE NODE · DYNAMIC INDUSTRY OR CITY BECOMES THE GROWTH POLE · SUPPLIERS, LABOUR AND MARKETS CLUSTER AROUND THE POLE · SPREAD EFFECT · BENEFITS DIFFUSE OUTWARD IF LINKAGES DEEPEN LOCALLY · A POLE MAY REMAIN AN ENCLAVE WITHOUT REGIONAL DIFFUSION

PROPULSIVE NODE → dynamic industry or city becomes the growth pole → LINKAGES → suppliers, labour and markets cluster around the pole → SPREAD EFFECT → benefits diffuse outward if linkages deepen locally → LIMIT → a pole may remain an enclave without regional diffusion

CORE CLAIM
- PROPULSIVE NODE → dynamic industry or city becomes the growth pole
- LINKAGES → suppliers, labour and markets cluster around the pole

MECHANISM
- SPREAD EFFECT → benefits diffuse outward if linkages deepen locally
- LIMIT → a pole may remain an enclave without regional diffusion

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- PROPULSIVE NODE → dynamic industry or city becomes the growth pole
- LINKAGES → suppliers, labour and markets cluster around the pole

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT → a pole may remain an enclave without regional diffusion.

03 STAGE 03 — CORE-PERIPHERY AND BACKWASH

CORE-PERIPHERY AND BACKWASH · CAPITAL, SERVICES, INFRASTRUCTURE AND DECISION POWER CONCENTRATE · LABOUR, RAW MATERIALS AND DEMAND ARE ORGANISED AROUND THE · TALENT AND CAPITAL DRAIN OUTWARD TOWARD THE CORE · TECHNOLOGY AND DEMAND MAY DIFFUSE, BUT NOT AUTOMATICALLY

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
CORE → capital, services, infrastructure and decision power concentrate	BACKWASH → talent and capital drain outward toward the core	CORE → capital, services, infrastructure and decision power concentrate
PERIPHERY → labour, raw materials and demand are organised around the core	SPREAD → technology and demand may diffuse, but not automatically	PERIPHERY → labour, raw materials and demand are organised around the core

CORE CLAIM
- CORE → capital, services, infrastructure and decision power concentrate
- PERIPHERY → labour, raw materials and demand are organised around the core

MECHANISM
- BACKWASH → talent and capital drain outward toward the core
- SPREAD → technology and demand may diffuse, but not automatically

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- CORE → capital, services, infrastructure and decision power concentrate
- PERIPHERY → labour, raw materials and demand are organised around the core

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SPREAD → technology and demand may diffuse, but not automatically.

04 STAGE 04 — PLANNING REGION CRITERIA

PLANNING REGION CRITERIA · FUNCTIONAL UNITY · FLOWS AND LINKAGES HOLD THE REGION TOGETHER · ADMINISTRATIVE MANAGEABILITY · POLICY MUST ACTUALLY BE IMPLEMENTABLE · ECONOMIC + ECOLOGICAL VIABILITY · STRATEGY AND RESOURCE BASE MUST ALIGN · SOCIAL ACCEPTABILITY

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
FUNCTIONAL UNITY → flows and linkages hold the region together	ECONOMIC + ECOLOGICAL VIABILITY → strategy and resource base must align	FUNCTIONAL UNITY → flows and linkages hold the region together
ADMINISTRATIVE MANAGEABILITY → policy must actually be implementable	SOCIAL ACCEPTABILITY → regional identity and needs affect success	ADMINISTRATIVE MANAGEABILITY → policy must actually be implementable

CORE CLAIM
- FUNCTIONAL UNITY → flows and linkages hold the region together
- ADMINISTRATIVE MANAGEABILITY → policy must actually be implementable

MECHANISM
- ECONOMIC + ECOLOGICAL VIABILITY → strategy and resource base must align
- SOCIAL ACCEPTABILITY → regional identity and needs affect success

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- FUNCTIONAL UNITY → flows and linkages hold the region together
- ADMINISTRATIVE MANAGEABILITY → policy must actually be implementable

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SOCIAL ACCEPTABILITY → regional identity and needs affect success.

05 STAGE 05 — INDIAN PLANNING TIMELINE

INDIAN PLANNING TIMELINE · NATIONAL PLANNING COMMITTEE BEGINS THE PLANNING IMAGINATION · PLANNING COMMISSION SET UP AND FIRST PLAN LAUNCHED · ANNUAL PLANS AFTER WAR, DROUGHT AND MACRO STRESS · TWELFTH PLAN LAST CYCLE; NITI REPLACES PLANNING COMMISSION

1938 → National Planning Committee begins the planning imagination → 1950-51 → Planning Commission set up and First Plan launched → 1966-69 → Annual Plans after war, drought and macro stress → 2012-17 / 2015 → Twelfth Plan last cycle; NITI replaces Planning Commision

CORE CLAIM
- 1938 → National Planning Committee begins the planning imagination
- 1950-51 → Planning Commission set up and First Plan launched

MECHANISM
- 1966-69 → Annual Plans after war, drought and macro stress
- 2012-17 / 2015 → Twelfth Plan last cycle; NITI replaces Planning Commission

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- 1938 → National Planning Committee begins the planning imagination
- 1950-51 → Planning Commission set up and First Plan launched

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 2012-17 / 2015 → Twelfth Plan last cycle; NITI replaces Planning Commission.

06 STAGE 06 — FIRST VERSUS SECOND PLAN

FIRST VERSUS SECOND PLAN · FIRST PLAN · IRRIGATION, AGRICULTURE, REFUGEE RESETTLEMENT, POWER · SECOND PLAN · HEAVY INDUSTRY AND PUBLIC-SECTOR INDUSTRIAL BASE · SPATIAL LOGIC · AGRARIAN RECOVERY FIRST, INDUSTRIAL CONCENTRATION NEXT · DO NOT SWAP THE PRIORITIES OF THE TWO PLANS

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
FIRST PLAN → irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power	SPATIAL LOGIC → agrarian recovery first, industrial concentration next	FIRST PLAN → irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power
SECOND PLAN → heavy industry and public-sector industrial base	TRAP → do not swap the priorities of the two plans	SECOND PLAN → heavy industry and public-sector industrial base

CORE CLAIM
- FIRST PLAN → irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power
- SECOND PLAN → heavy industry and public-sector industrial base

MECHANISM
- SPATIAL LOGIC → agrarian recovery first, industrial concentration next
- TRAP → do not swap the priorities of the two plans

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- FIRST PLAN → irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power
- SECOND PLAN → heavy industry and public-sector industrial base

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → do not swap the priorities of the two plans.

07 STAGE 07 — WHY IMBALANCE PERSISTED

WHY IMBALANCE PERSISTED · UNEVEN IRRIGATION · GREEN REVOLUTION GAINS STAYED REGIONALLY SELECTIVE · INDUSTRIAL CONCENTRATION · PORTS, METROS AND CORRIDORS PULLED AHEAD · CONNECTIVITY + GOVERNANCE GAPS · INTERIORS REMAINED INFRASTRUCTURE-POOR · BALANCED REGIONAL DEVELOPMENT STAYED INCOMPLETE

UNEVEN IRRIGATION → Green Revolution gains stayed regionally selective → INDUSTRIAL CONCENTRATION → ports, metros and corridors pulled ahead → CONNECTIVITY + GOVERNANCE GAPS → interiors remained infrastructure-poor → OUTCOME → balanced regional development stayed incomplete

CORE CLAIM
- UNEVEN IRRIGATION → Green Revolution gains stayed regionally selective
- INDUSTRIAL CONCENTRATION → ports, metros and corridors pulled ahead

MECHANISM
- CONNECTIVITY + GOVERNANCE GAPS → interiors remained infrastructure-poor
- OUTCOME → balanced regional development stayed incomplete

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- UNEVEN IRRIGATION → Green Revolution gains stayed regionally selective
- INDUSTRIAL CONCENTRATION → ports, metros and corridors pulled ahead

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CONNECTIVITY + GOVERNANCE GAPS → interiors remained infrastructure-poor.

08 STAGE 08 — PLANNING COMMISSION VERSUS NITI

PLANNING COMMISSION VERSUS NITI · PLANNING COMMISSION · CENTRALISED PLAN FORMULATION AND OUTLAY LOGIC · NITI AAYOG · THINK-TANK COORDINATION, COMPETITIVE AND COOPERATIVE FEDERALISM · PLAN DOCUMENTS · LONG-HORIZON ALLOCATION FRAMEWORK · INDICATOR MONITORING AND MISSION-MODE COMPARISON

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
PLANNING COMMISSION → centralised plan formulation and outlay logic	PLAN DOCUMENTS → long-horizon allocation framework	PLANNING COMMISSION → centralised plan formulation and outlay logic
NITI AAYOG → think-tank coordination, competitive and cooperative federalism	DASHBOARDS → indicator monitoring and mission-mode comparison	NITI AAYOG → think-tank coordination, competitive and cooperative federalism

CORE CLAIM
- PLANNING COMMISSION → centralised plan formulation and outlay logic
- NITI AAYOG → think-tank coordination, competitive and cooperative federalism

MECHANISM
- PLAN DOCUMENTS → long-horizon allocation framework
- DASHBOARDS → indicator monitoring and mission-mode comparison

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- PLANNING COMMISSION → centralised plan formulation and outlay logic
- NITI AAYOG → think-tank coordination, competitive and cooperative federalism

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: NITI AAYOG → think-tank coordination, competitive and cooperative federalism.

09 STAGE 09 — DISTRICT AND BLOCK TARGETING LADDER

DISTRICT AND BLOCK TARGETING LADDER · STATE AVERAGE · USEFUL, BUT HIDES INTERNAL INEQUALITY · DISTRICT TARGETING · ASPIRATIONAL DISTRICTS BRINGS LAGGING DISTRICTS INTO FOCUS · BLOCK TARGETING · SCALE MOVES FURTHER DOWNWARD WHERE DISTRICT AVERAGES STILL HIDE · GEOGRAPHIC LESSON

STATE AVERAGE → useful but hides internal inequality

DISTRICT TARGETING → Aspirational Districts brings lagging districts into focus → BLOCK TARGETING → scale moves further downward where district averages still hide gaps → GEOGRAPHIC LESSON → intra-state disparity is a first-order planning problem

CORE CLAIM
- STATE AVERAGE → useful but hides internal inequality
- DISTRICT TARGETING → Aspirational Districts brings lagging districts into focus
- BLOCK TARGETING → scale moves further downward where district averages still hide gaps

MECHANISM
- GEOGRAPHIC LESSON → intra-state disparity is a first-order planning problem
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Five Year Plans ended after the Twelfth Plan period and the Planning
- Commission was replaced by NITI Aayog in 2015

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- plan strategy, Finance Commission transfers, centrally sponsored schemes, NITI cooperative/competitive federalism and constitutional local planning are institutionally distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Commission was replaced by NITI Aayog in 2015; plan strategy, Finance Commission transfers, centrally sponsored schemes, NITI cooperative/competitive federalism and constitutional local planning are institutionally distinct.

10 STAGE 10 — SDG-STYLE BENCHMARKING

SDG-STYLE BENCHMARKING · SDG INDIA INDEX 2023-24 · OVERALL INDIA SCORE 71 · TERRITORIAL INDICATORS · DEVELOPMENT IS RANKED SPATIALLY, NOT ONLY NATIONALLY · CURRENT STYLE · DASHBOARDS COMPLEMENT MISSIONS AND PROGRAMME CONVERGENCE · SAFE USE

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
SDG INDIA INDEX 2023-24 → overall India score 71	SAFE USE → planning changed form, but not the geography of disparity	convergence is an empirical result, not an automatic consequence of investment.
TERRITORIAL INDICATORS → development is ranked spatially, not only nationally	EVIDENCE LIMIT: Damodar Valley, NCR, Dandakaranya, command areas, hill/tribal regions.	
CURRENT STYLE → dashboards complement missions and programme convergence	Aspirational Districts and freight/industrial corridors show that growth-node benefits depend on linkages, displacement, skills, ecology and state capacity	

CORE CLAIM
- SDG INDIA INDEX 2023-24 → overall India score 71
- TERRITORIAL INDICATORS → development is ranked spatially, not only nationally
- CURRENT STYLE → dashboards complement missions and programme convergence

MECHANISM
- SAFE USE → planning changed form, but not the geography of disparity
- EVIDENCE LIMIT: Damodar Valley, NCR, Dandakaranya, command areas, hill/tribal regions.
- Aspirational Districts and freight/industrial corridors show that growth-node benefits depend on linkages, displacement, skills, ecology and state capacity

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- convergence is an empirical result, not an automatic consequence of investment.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Aspirational Districts and freight/industrial corridors show that growth-node benefits depend on linkages, displacement, skills, ecology and state capacity; convergence is an empirical result, not an automatic consequence of investment.

11 STAGE 11 — REGIONAL DEVELOPMENT ANSWER SPINE

REGIONAL DEVELOPMENT ANSWER SPINE · DISPARITY VERSUS DIVERSITY AND THE MEANING OF REGIONAL PLANNING · GROWTH POLE, CORE-PERIPHERY, SPREAD AND BACKWASH · 1938 COMMITTEE, FIRST PLAN, SECOND PLAN, NITI TRANSITION · DISTRICT DASHBOARDS MATTER BECAUSE STATE AVERAGES CONCEAL DISPARITY

DEFINE → disparity versus diversity and the meaning of regional planning → EXPLAIN → growth pole, core-periphery, spread and backwash → TRACE → 1938 committee, First Plan, Second Plan, NITI transition → QUALIFY → district dashboards matter because state averages conceal disparity

CORE CLAIM
- DEFINE → disparity versus diversity and the meaning of regional planning
- EXPLAIN → growth pole, core-periphery, spread and backwash

MECHANISM
- TRACE → 1938 committee, First Plan, Second Plan, NITI transition
- QUALIFY → district dashboards matter because state averages conceal disparity

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- DEFINE → disparity versus diversity and the meaning of regional planning
- EXPLAIN → growth pole, core-periphery, spread and backwash

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: QUALIFY → district dashboards matter because state averages conceal disparity.

E EXTRA — SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · ONE INTERPRETATION SAYS INDIA HAS MOVED FROM CENTRALISED FIVE-YEAR · ANOTHER SAYS THE UNDERLYING ISSUE REMAINS THE SAME · HOW TO REDUCE · REGIONAL IMBALANCE IN LAGGING DISTRICTS, SMALL TOWNS, TRIBAL BELTS · A GOOD MAINS ANSWER SHOULD THEREFORE TREAT NITI AS · THE PLANNING COMMISSION WAS REPLACED BY NITI AAYOG ON · THE TWELFTH PLAN WAS THE LAST FIVE-YEAR PLAN CYCLE.

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH
- CAUTION: One interpretation says India has moved from centralised Five-Year Plans to more flexible mission-based and state-compared governance.
- CAUTION: Another says the underlying issue remains the same: how to reduce
- regional imbalance in lagging districts, small towns, tribal belts and infrastructure-poor interiors.
- CAUTION: A good Mains answer should therefore treat NITI as a change in planning style, not the end of planning geography.

ADVANCED DEBATE
- The Planning Commission was replaced by NITI Aayog on 1 January 2015.
- The Twelfth Plan was the last Five-Year Plan cycle.
- Balanced regional development remained an explicit concern but an incomplete achievement.
- Aspirational Districts Programme targets districts, not states as a whole.

LEGACY / NUANCE
- SDG India Index is a territorial-development benchmarking tool.
- NOT: NITI Aayog is simply the Planning Commission with a new name – The institutional style and policy mechanism changed significantly.
- NOT: Ending Five-Year Plans ended planning – Planning continues through missions, indices, state coordination and targeted programmes.
- NOT: Regional imbalance is only about poor states – It also exists within states, between districts and between metros and hinterlands.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels